

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Protecting Our Global Village.



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write an opinion paragraph about environmental problems.
- I can write about things that have happened.
- I can write about facts about events or actions.

Ask your partner:

- Do you recycle on a regular basis? Why or why not?
- What do you think is the most important factor in reducing our impact on the environment?





Let's Explore!

Future generations are relying on us to make environmentally-friendly decisions. Can we change our current **trajectory***?

* "Trajectory" means a process of change or development that leads toward a particular result.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Pollution has become a major issue facing the international community. However, dealing with recycling, waste treatment, and soil and water contamination is not a new phenomenon.

Conferences and international summits are regularly held to discuss the need for greater commitments by nations and to recognize the impact of human waste on the natural environment.

Indeed, an international approach, that will provide joint efforts between nations, is paramount in the fight against pollution.

Governments should be proactive and offer support to companies and organizations that are involved in manufacturing, industry or agriculture in order to encourage environmentally-friendly approaches.

We have developed the means to change our current trajectory with modern technology and require a shift in social values.

These could be introduced as special laws, certificates, tax incentives and recycling programs. However, this epidemic is not only the responsibility of country leaders.

Individuals must also share in the responsibility. In the past, people might not have thought about their negative impact on the planet or may have considered the problem to be too big to think about. Yet, simple acts like switching off appliances and personal items can make significant differences over time.

People, who have tended to avoid recycling in the past, should think about separating waste materials and encouraging recycling practices. Furthermore, individuals who have previously used private vehicles, should consider using public transport as an environmentally-friendly alternative. What it amounts to is making conscious choices about how you want to affect your surrounding. We mustn't let our selfishness dictate the future of others. To sum up, environmental problems are everyone's responsibility. Both local and international authorities as well as individuals need to make a concerted effort to minimize society's imprint on nature and preserve our planet for future generations.



Let's Practice!

The environment is everyone's problem.

Instructions: Select the correct answer and write it in its corresponding space.

1. will become / has become / becomes
 2. regularly hold / are regularly held / are holding
 3. have developed / have develop / develops
 4. be / has been / are
-
1. Pollution _____ a major issue facing the international community in the last fifty years.
 2. Conferences and international summits _____ to discuss the need for greater commitments by nations.
 3. We _____ the means to change our current trajectory.
 4. Since major recycling initiatives were introduced, there _____ little change in the amount of garbage being produced.



Let's Practice!

Let's write about facts and events.

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to correctly complete each sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Please add a box with the word bank words. This box should be called "Word Bank" in bold.

Word Bank

who have tended / that is involved / environmentally-friendly /
that will promote / that are involved / alternative / is promoting /
paramount / tends / recycling / who have previously used

1. Indeed, an international approach, _____ joint efforts between nations, is _____ in the fight against pollution.
2. Governments should be proactive and offer support to companies and organizations _____ in manufacturing, industry, or agriculture in order to encourage _____ approaches.
3. People _____ to avoid recycling in the past should think about separating waste materials and encouraging _____ practices.
4. Furthermore, individuals _____ private vehicles should consider using public transport as an environmentally-friendly _____.





Extension Activity

Let me convince you.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research an environmental problem online or at your local library.
- What is your opinion about the situation?
- Write a 14-16 line dialogue between you and a friend in which you are expressing an opinion about the environmental problem.
- State your main idea and supporting facts.
- Include different points of view.
- Read your dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research an environmental problem.

☐ ☐

I write a dialogue where the characters express different opinions on a subject.

☐ ☐

I read the dialogue about an environmental problem aloud with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **contamination** (noun): the process of making something dangerous, dirty, or impure by adding something harmful or undesirable to it
e.g. However, dealing with recycling, waste treatment, and soil and water contamination is not a new phenomenon.
- **paramount** (noun): very important
e.g. Indeed, an international approach, that will promote joint efforts between nations, is paramount in the fight against pollution.
- **incentive** (noun): something that encourages a person to do something or to work harder
e.g. These could be introduced as special laws, certificates, tax incentives and recycling programs.
- **to dictate** (verb): to say or state something with authority or power
e.g. We mustn't let our selfishness dictate the future of others.
- **to preserve** (verb): to keep something in its original state or in good condition
e.g. We need to preserve our planet for future generations.
- **concerted** (adjective): done in a planned and deliberate way usually by several or many people
e.g. Both local and international authorities as well as individuals need to make a concerted effort to minimize society's imprint on nature.





Learning Points

Writing Tips for the Present Perfect

You can use the **Present Perfect** tense to talk about an event in the past that occurred at an unimportant or unknown time.

The Present Perfect is formed in the following manner:

Subject	Have or Has	Past Participle	Compliment
<i>I</i>	<i>have</i>	<i>visited</i>	<i>many countries</i>
<i>Vanessa</i>	<i>has</i>	<i>seen</i>	<i>that movie three times.</i>

Note: Sometimes the past participle form of the verb is **the same** as the past simple form of the verb.

For example:

*I have **visited** many countries.*
*I **visited** many countries in 2007.*

Sometimes the past participle form of the verb is **different** from the past simple form of the verb.

For example:

*Vanessa has **seen** that movie three times.*
*Vanessa **saw** that movie yesterday.*

The Present Perfect can provide a specific starting time or a duration of time only if **for** or **since** is used.

For example:

*She has lived in Chicago **for** ten years.*
*She has lived in Chicago **since** 2005.*





Learning Points

Look at the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Pollution has become a major issue facing the international community.*
- *Conferences and international summits are regularly held to discuss the need for greater commitments by nations and to recognize the impact of human waste on the natural environment.*
- *We have developed the means to change our current trajectory with modern technology and require a shift in social values.*
- *Since major recycling initiatives were introduced, there has been little change in the amount of garbage being produced.*

Writing Tips for Relative Clauses

You can provide extra information about someone or something by using a relative clause. Be careful though because a relative clause can not be used on its own. This will create a sentence fragment.

A relative clause provides additional information. It does not express a complete thought. As a result a relative clause must always be used in combination with a main clause.

Correct:

Nolan took the bicycle which his brother had loaned him.

Incorrect (sentence fragment):

~~*His brother had loaned him.*~~

Correct:

Xavier gave a gift to his brother, who thanked him profusely.

Incorrect (sentence fragment):

~~*Who thanked him profusely.*~~





Learning Points

A relative clause can contain essential information or non-essential information.

If a relative clause contains essential information, then a comma **is not** needed.

For example:

The man who delivered the newspaper was late.

If a relative clause contains non-essential information, then a comma **is** needed.

For example:

My father, who was born in 1962, worked as a machinist.

Examples:

- *People who have tended to avoid recycling in the past should think about separating waste materials and encouraging recycling practices.*
- *Furthermore, individuals who have previously used private vehicles should consider using public transport as an environmentally-friendly alternative.*
- *Indeed, an international approach that will promote joint efforts between nations is paramount in the fight against pollution.*
- *Governments should be proactive and offer support to companies and organizations that are involved in manufacturing, industry or agriculture in order to encourage environmentally-friendly approaches.*

